



WRITER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Writers work to inform, educate, or entertain their readers. They are skilled at using the written word to convey meaning or to tell stories, and work in a huge range of industries in diverse roles. Some writers achieve fame by writing novels or working as journalists or screenwriters, but many more make their living by writing press releases, articles for magazines and websites, or copy (text) for advertisements.



SALARY

Varies enormously depending on the type of writing and experience

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Increasing demand for writers in online media • Fierce competition for work in every sector • Work predominantly freelance based

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Writing • Languages • Literature and reading • Performing arts • Drama • Technical and scientific subjects



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS There are no specific requirements. Some have higher degrees in professional or creative writing; others have little formal training.



LIFESTYLE Many writers are self-employed and set their own working hours. They usually need to meet deadlines set by publishers.



LOCATION Writers may work on a computer in an office, a library, or at home. They sometimes need to travel to meet clients or conduct interviews.



THE REALITIES A writer's earnings can be as unpredictable as their workload. Writing is an isolating experience, and all writers need great perseverance.

CAREER PATHS

The majority of writers work on a freelance basis, specializing in one of many areas, from children's books to technical manuals. As with many other creative jobs, there is no formal career structure, and some people can become writers without undergoing any training. Reputation, talent, and experience count for more than any qualifications.

BLOGGER Writing a personal blog or contributing to a college magazine gives you a chance to develop your writing skills. Showing your work to online or print publishers may win you a paid commission.



GRADUATE A degree in English or creative writing is useful, but not required. You may be better off earning a degree in another area that enables you to become a writer on a specialized subject.

